

Aly Wheale

Product Design Consultant · Design Systems · Enterprise & Data-Dense Products · AI/ML Tooling

🕒 Available from mid-September 2026 · 20–30 hrs/wk · consulting engagements or longer contracts

📍 Greater Boston, MA · fully remote, US

✦ US permanent resident · no sponsorship required

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Profile

I consult on the parts of a product that are hard to make simple: design systems, complex search and filtering, compliance workflows and machine-learning tooling. **11 years in enterprise software** at HP, Micro Focus and Smarsh, first as a front-end engineer and later leading design. I read the codebase and hand over work engineers can build from.

How I work with clients

- **Design system audit (2 to 4 weeks):** Assessing an existing component library, finding the drift, and recommending structure, variants, states and documentation.
- **UX audit of a complex product (1 to 2 weeks):** A structured review of search and filtering, dense tables, dashboards, bulk actions and multi-step flows, with prioritised findings.
- **AI/ML tooling interfaces:** Model evaluation and comparison, classification review, human-in-the-loop workflows, communicating confidence and error.
- **Embedded design support:** Longer part-time engagements alongside front-end teams. Prototypes over specifications.
- **Discovery and concept sprint (about a week):** Turning a written requirement or rough idea into wireframes quickly, so teams can argue about something concrete.

Experience

Independent Designer & Illustrator

Self-employed

May 2025 to Present

- Contract illustration for Derry Comics; scoping, quoting, revision cycles, delivery to deadline.

- **Search redesign (2024):** One of the designers on the Enterprise Archive search rebuild. My work covered the single typeahead filter input parsing operators, units and file types into structured filters, editable filter chips, pinnable saved searches, column toggling and result refinement.
- **UX research:** Usability sessions and user-group evaluation, plus product analytics in Datadog to map real user journeys and establish which features were used and which were not.
- **ML model evaluation analytics:** Interface for comparing up to four model versions across true/false positive and negative rates on communications datasets, with charted summaries and per-message comparison.
- **Review and supervision workflow:** Faceted message search, bulk review actions, flagging for violation, privilege and further review.
- **Case management and policy engine:** Legal hold, custodians, case states; drag-and-drop policy prioritisation with dependency and short-circuit handling.
- **Design system:** Contributed components and variants to the Angular-based Integrated Design System.

Design Consultant **Soho Squared**

2019 to 2022, concurrent

- **Speech² speech-analytics platform:** Call search with transcript, waveform and sentiment; agent performance dashboards; real-time Agent Assist with sentiment alerts and de-escalation prompts; entity and policy authoring with regex conditions.
- **Agent evaluation and appeals:** Scoring forms with regulation-critical questions, review queues and a supervisor appeal workflow. Figma component sets with variants; identity and colour system.

UX Lead / Senior UX Designer **Micro Focus (now OpenText)**

2017 to Feb 2022

- Led design across Digital Safe (private-cloud archiving at scale) and Search Optimiser. Ran a team.
- Defined the two-stage UX process used inside the development lifecycle, adopted across product teams.

Software Engineer to UX Lead **HP / Hewlett Packard Enterprise**

2013 to Jan 2017

- Front-end engineer, later UX lead, on HPE IDOL big-data and machine-learning analytics applications.
- Designed and shipped the Search Augmentation Tool (successor to Autonomy Business Console), IDOL Answer Bank and Find enterprise search.

Earlier · Leto Lab · ECS STACS · University of Southampton. UI Software Engineer; System Administrator; UX Designer (research contract) · 2011 to 2013

DESIGN

- Design systems
- Component libraries
- Interaction design
- Information architecture
- Data-dense dashboards
- Faceted filtering
- Progressive-disclosure wizards
- Wireframing (lo-fi to hi-fi)
- Prototyping
- Accessibility-conscious design

RESEARCH

- Personas
- User stories
- Market & competitor analysis
- Usability testing
- Empathy mapping
- Storyboarding

TOOLS

Figma

Sketch

Balsamiq

InVision

Adobe Illustrator

Photoshop

Procreate

Jira

Confluence

DOMAINS

Compliance & archiving

Enterprise search

ML/AI tooling

Speech analytics

NLP & conversational AI

Contact-centre QM

Financial services

B2B SaaS

LANGUAGES

English

Fluent

Russian

Fluent

Spanish

Intermediate

EDUCATION

MEng Computer Science

HCI & Cognitive Behaviour

University of Southampton

2009 to 2013

ENGINEERING BACKGROUND

CS degree; shipped production front-end code at HP/HPE: JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Java, Python, Git. Code-literate: I read a codebase and judge what a change costs.

AI-ASSISTED WORK

Prototyping and proof-of-concept builds with AI tooling. Design for ML products: model evaluation, classification review, sentiment and NLP output.

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